

2. Difference Between Blind Faith and Proper Faith

The sources make a sharp distinction between **blind faith**, which is described as useless or fanaticism, and **proper faith**, which is scientific and based on authorized knowledge.



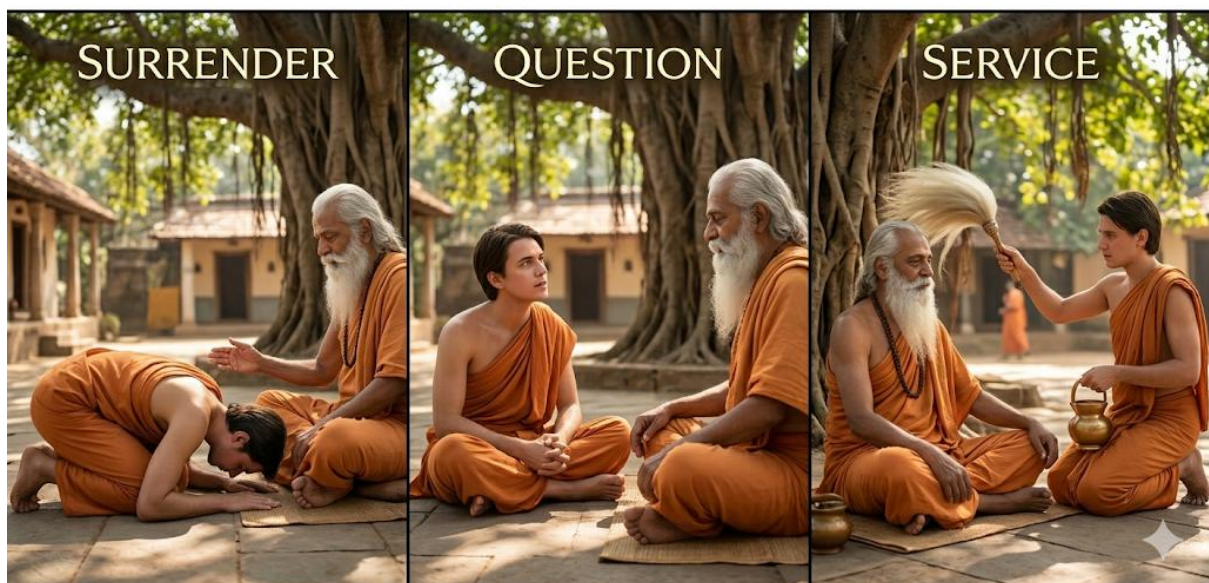
Reference 1: Lecture, Bhagavad-gītā 4.39–5.3, August 19, 1966, New York
<https://vedabase.io/en/library/transcripts/660819bg-new-york/#bb577582>

Now Lord Kṛṣṇa says that faithful, those who are faithful, they can acquire transcendental knowledge. This subject matter we have discussed in the last meeting, that without faith we cannot make any progress. In any field of activities, we must have faith. For example, I cited the other day, just like we go to your barber shop, and we spread our neck, and the barber has got a sharp razor in his hand. If he likes, he can at once cut my throat; he has got the weapon ready. But because I have got faith, he'll not do it—he'll simply shave my beard or Mustaches.

So, this faith is required in every activity. Without faith we cannot step forward even in our daily life. So, if we have got so, so faith in ordinary dealings, don't you think that we must have very good faith when we are making progress in spiritual life?

But faith should not be blind. **Blind faith is useless.** Now, we have already discussed that one should go to the spiritual master with surrender and question and service—three things. First of all, for acquiring knowledge we have to find out the suitable personality, and if we are fortunate enough to find out such suitable personality, then first thing is to surrender. And that, after that surrender, there are questions. One must be very intelligent to put questions to the spiritual master. Without questions you cannot make progress.

“ONE MUST GO TO THE SPIRITUAL MASTER WITH SURRENDER, QUESTION, AND SERVICE.”



So blind faith is never required, neither questions should be in a mood of challenge.



Reference 2: Lecture, Bhagavad-gītā 7.2, September 11, 1968, San Francisco

<https://vedabase.io/en/library/transcripts/680911bg-san-francisco/#bb527786>

(Accepting the existence of God and His laws is not blind faith)

Nature means God's law. Automatically working. Foolish people do not see God's law, but there is God's law. The sun is rising exactly in time; the moon is rising exactly in time. The first year, first January, has come exactly in time. **So, there is control.** But foolish people, they do not see it. Everything is controlled.

So, to know God and how things are working and how it is being controlled,

we should not go simply by sentiment. Religious sentiment is good for persons who follow blindly.

But at the present moment, people are advanced in so-called education. So Bhagavad-gītā gives you full information so that you can accept God with your reason, with your argument, with your knowledge. It is not blind following. Kṛṣṇa consciousness is not a sentiment. It is backed by knowledge and practical knowledge.

jñānaṁ te 'haṁ sa-vijñānam
idaṁ vakṣyāmy aśeṣataḥ
yaj jñātvā neha bhūyo 'nyaj
jñātavyam avaśiṣyate

I shall now declare unto you in full this knowledge, both phenomenal and numinous. This being known, nothing further shall remain for you to know.

BG 7.2

Complete knowledge means understanding matter, spirit, and the supreme source of both. This knowledge is received through devotion and proper disciplic succession from the Lord.